Afterwards.

This poem Afterwards is written by (Thomas Hardy) On this poem he is talking about the time when he will no longer be active, he wonders what people will say about him when he is dead.

On this first stanza, he speaks about a future time when the present is shut after his lifetime the speaker is thrives a month of may which is associated with renewal and vitality. the flapping of the leaves, gives him a sense of hope and he always enjoys the close company of nature, he wonders whether his neighbours will say that,

"He was a man who appreciated the small beauties of life."

On stanza two of the poem the speaker introduces the image of the hawk who sits on the thorn tree which is situated on small hill. Someone who obs-erves this might wonder that this kind of seen must have been a familiar sight to the poet.

On stanza three we find that the poet talks about a situation when he is crossing a dark night. He will possibly noted a small hedgehog crossing the lawn. People will probably say that the speaker cared for and protected innocent creature who lived in the open fields. Yet, he cannot prove anything for animals now because,

"he is gone".

the observer laments the fact that if the poet had been alive, then he would have shown kindness and compassion for small and weak animals.

On the next stanza he talks about a situation when people will gather at his house after hearing about his death, they will watch the winter sky which is full of stars that image is that of cold and darkness. When this people come to pay there respect the poet wonders if they will think that this man had an interest in the mysteries of the natural world.

In the concluding stanza the poet anticipates the time when the funeral bell will rings in the passing wind interrupts the sound for sometime by tolling the bell, after the interruption and it is like a new sound. People will perhaps comment that the poet can no longer hear the bell now, but he was such a person used to pay attention to such details when he was alive. In conclusion we can say that the poet Thomas Hardy imagines the idea of the reaer^n of common people after he is dead, he feels that he should be remembered for being an observer of nature and someone who appreciated the beautiful mysteries of life.